Report to the Elder: Aftermath – Mission 3, Excavation Site

The Silent Axiom's Report – Xolkan, 26SEP26

Honored Elder of the Silent Communion,

Grace and the resonance of the Silent Axiom be with you. I send this report from low orbit above Xolkan, after our withdrawal from the wreckage fields. The cascade that followed the Ontranis shard tore the second Voidcrown signature from its sleep. The Voidsun's gaze is no longer a distant weight. It watches the dig.

Wave-scanners marked several buried resonances beneath the old Frog-Mage pits. We came with drills, battlesuits, a heavy stealth suit, a hover bike, and a hover transport, intending first to treat with whoever already held the ground. The site was occupied. Scouts named them the Cult of Excessive Violence, a wandering host of War Disciples under the warlord Chudgore: rifle-cultists bearing sniper and plasma arms, infernal brutes, mutated war brothers, and war destroyers whose fists burned with stolen fire. Words failed. They answered the Covenant with hunger.

The brutes came as vanguard, the cultists close behind. Our spotters seized a dig and painted the forward brute for focused fire. The wound only taught him greed. He drove his fist into the earth above a shard-signature and scooped like a living excavator—until a derelict demolition charge answered. Dirt and infernal flesh painted the trench. I cannot call that the Oracle's mercy. The charges were laid long before we arrived, and they showed no favor.

One spotter element awakened an abandoned mining drill over a second signature and found the same buried spite. The blast tore the team and took a brother's dominant arm. Ambushing war brothers then fell upon my tactical grunts. We held the line as the Axiom demands, even as the destroyers caught our battlesuits unready and clove them with energy fists. What began as a frontal clash became a two-front slaughter, with the Silent Axiom pressed in the middle. Spotter-lasers guided the heavy stealth suit onto the last brute and brought him down. The hover bike claimed a dig only to be cut apart by plasma fire before it could work the earth. Cultists took the site beneath the wreck and vanished into an old teleporter-gate; I do not know where the wreckage sent them. Our hover transport met a similar gate soon after and was likewise stolen from the field.

We investigated the tactical markings the Oracle required, yet the remaining signature began to move of their own accord, as if the shard itself crawled from the noise. Chudgore's survivors found it and dragged it from the fray. We were too brutalized to pursue. I ordered the remnant back to the ship.

I give thanks for the lives that remain and for the warning written in moving stone. The Cult is a blunt instrument, yet they now carry a key the storms will recognize. I await your interpretation and further directive, that we may yet recover what was lost or deny it to those who would misuse the Voidsun's power.

The Covenant endures. The Oracle will not be denied.

Deacon-Champion Amos Vyrn
The Covenant of the Silent Axiom